

V2 Revamp vs. Legacy Website

A detailed walkthrough of the Sinister Diesel V2 frontend rebuild — its architecture, how it works, exactly how it differs from the current Legacy storefront, why it is a stronger foundation, and what still remains before activation.

V2 Revamp

From-scratch frontend

Legacy

Currently live

Engine

Miva Merchant (unchanged)

Governance

V2_CONSTITUTION.md

CONTENTS

1. Executive summary
2. What "V2" actually is
3. How the platform works (Miva + frontend)
4. Architecture: Legacy vs. V2
5. The V2 design system in depth
6. Component library & reusability
7. JavaScript & interaction layer
8. Real data vs. hardcoded values
9. Defects found & fixed
10. Third-party / dependency risk
11. Feature-by-feature comparison
12. Why V2 is better — reasoned
13. Migration approach & safety
14. Outstanding work & known risks

Status: V2 is a governed, milestone-based rebuild. Every V2 template and partial is created **inactive** — building or editing one does not put it live. All Legacy templates remain live and untouched. Authoritative specs: [V2_CONSTITUTION.md](#) and [V2_STRUCTURE.md](#).

1 Executive summary

The Legacy storefront was built page-by-page. Each template carried its own copy-pasted markup and inline styling, and several values (support phone, "latest blog" cards) were hardcoded into the markup at build time. It works, but it is inconsistent, hard to change, and easy to break.

V2 rebuilds the same store on a **single shared design system** ([css/sd2-global.css](#)), a library of **reusable canonical components**, and **real store data** pulled from Miva tokens instead of duplicated code and baked-in values. The commerce engine — Miva Merchant — is **unchanged**; only the visible frontend is redesigned. The result is a storefront that is more consistent, far

easier to maintain, more trustworthy in the content it shows, lower-risk on third-party dependencies, and enriched with a premium motion/interaction layer the Legacy site does not have.

2 What "V2" actually is

Sinister Diesel's storefront runs on **Miva Merchant**. Miva stays the commerce engine — products, categories, basket, checkout, accounts, orders, URLs, SEO, search, MVT templating, forms, APIs, analytics, and integrations all keep working. **Only the visible frontend is being redesigned.**

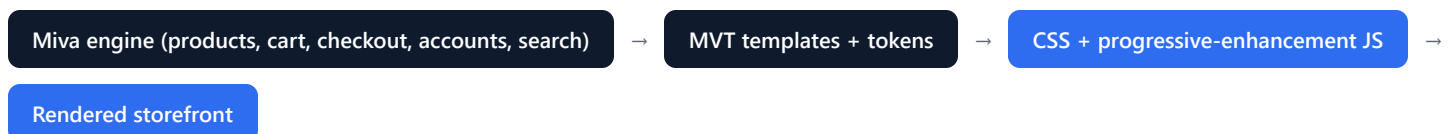
- **V2** = the new frontend. **Legacy** = the existing live frontend.
- Legacy is **never deleted and never modified** by V2 work.
- V2 templates/partials are created **inactive** — a file goes live only when a human manually assigns it to a copied test page in Miva Admin and reviews it.
- Creative direction is a premium performance garage / motorsport engineering / American manufacturing / automotive-tech brand — deliberately **not** a generic Shopify/WooCommerce/Bootstrap/ReadyTheme catalog.

NAMING CONVENTION

Legacy: plain names (`sfnt.mvt` , `srch.mvt` , `bask.mvt`). · V2 staging: `-v2` suffix (`sfnt-v2.mvt` , `ctgy-v2.mvt`). · V2 components: `sd2-v2-*` prefix. · CSS classes `.sd2-v2-*` , tokens `--sd2-*` , JS hooks `data-v2-*` .

3 How the platform works

Both Legacy and V2 render through the same Miva pipeline — the difference is entirely in the template/CSS/JS layer:



V2 changes only the last two stages. Data still comes from Miva integration points:

Data	Miva source
Basket / cart totals	<code>&mvt: basket : *</code> and BASK actions
Checkout / shipping / payment	OCST / OSEL / OPAY actions and gateway fields
Order history / detail	ORDH / ORDL / ORDS order arrays and links
Customer account data	ACLN / ACAD / ACED customer fields
Product data	PROD product fields, custom fields, related products
Search / Category data	SRCH result arrays · CTGY product/category arrays & facets
Garage fitment	future backend fitment data mapped to <code>sd2v2_garage</code>

4 Architecture: Legacy vs. V2

Legacy pattern

- Built page-by-page over time
- Per-template inline / duplicated CSS
- Copy-pasted markup blocks per page
- Some values hardcoded at build time
- Styling drifts between pages
- One change = edit many files
- No shared motion/interaction system

V2 pattern

- One global design system (`sd2-global.css`)
- All styling from `--sd2-*` tokens
- Reusable canonical partials
- Real store/blog data with fallbacks
- Consistent by construction
- One change propagates everywhere
- Shared progressive-enhancement JS + motion

The repository is exported/synced Miva theme content (no build system or package manager). Key locations: `templates/` (~1280 .mvt), `partials/` (V2 components), `css/sd2-global.css` (the single design system), `js/sd2-v2-components.js` (shared JS), and the governing `V2_CONSTITUTION.md` / `V2_STRUCTURE.md`.

5 The V2 design system in depth

There is **one** design system, in a single file: `css/sd2-global.css`.

- **Token-driven.** All colors, spacing, radius, shadow, typography, and motion are defined as `--sd2-*` tokens. No duplicated tokens or component CSS may exist in templates, partials, or inline.
- **Layered structure.** Organized tokens → layout → components → commerce → listing → search → PDP.
- **Token discipline.** CSS references `--sd2-*` tokens rather than hardcoded values, so a single edit restyles the whole site.

This is the core structural difference from Legacy: change a spacing or color token once, and every V2 component updates — versus hunting through duplicated inline CSS across many Legacy templates.

6 Component library & reusability

V2 ships a library of canonical components that pages **assemble** rather than re-declare. Each has one canonical location and one CSS namespace, and must not be duplicated inline:

Component	Canonical location	CSS namespace
Product Card	<code>sd2-v2-product-card.mvt</code>	<code>.sd2-v2-pcard*</code>
Listing filters	(in design system)	<code>.sd2-v2-filter-rail / -sheet / -chips / -pgrid</code>
Price block	<code>sd2-v2-price-block.mvt</code>	<code>.sd2-v2-price</code>
Quantity stepper	<code>sd2-v2-quantity-stepper.mvt</code>	<code>.sd2-v2-qty</code>
Badges	<code>sd2-v2-product-badges.mvt</code>	<code>.sd2-v2-badge</code>
Stock indicator	<code>sd2-v2-stock-indicator.mvt</code>	<code>.sd2-v2-stock</code>
Media / gallery	<code>sd2-v2-product-media.mvt</code>	<code>.sd2-v2-media</code>
Accordion	<code>sd2-v2-accordion.mvt</code>	<code>.sd2-v2-accordion</code>
Sticky buy bar	<code>sd2-v2-sticky-buy-bar.mvt</code>	<code>.sd2-v2-sticky-buy</code>
Garage selector	<code>sd2-v2-garage-selector.mvt</code>	(delegated triggers)

Additional families exist across header/navigation, mega menu, footer, cart drawer, search (results header, suggestions, empty state), category/listing engine, and account/basket. High-level inventory: ~24 commerce-foundation primitives, ~15 PDP sections, ~20 cart/checkout sections, ~18 dashboard sections (full list in `V2_STRUCTURE.md`). The Product Listing V2 **reuses** the canonical Product Card rather than embedding a duplicate.

7 JavaScript & interaction layer

Shared progressive-enhancement JS lives in `js/sd2-v2-components.js` with **no external dependencies**. Its rules make the frontend resilient and consistent:

- Modules initialize **only when their root hook** (`data-v2-*`) exists — they fail closed when a component is absent.
- All `localStorage` access is wrapped in `try/catch` to tolerate unavailable storage. Fixed keys never renamed: `sd2v2_garage` , `sd2v2_recent_searches` , `sd2_v2_recent_searches` .
- Component partials contain **no inline scripts or styles**.
- Garage toggles are delegated so account/cart/PDP controls all open the same canonical Garage component.
- Gallery switching, counters, thumbnail keyboard nav, and zoom are centralized in one gallery module.
- **Reduced-motion branches are required** everywhere motion is added: count-up, hover/motion, skeleton shimmer, filters, media, sticky buy, PDP tabs, cart progress, and drawer/sheet transitions.

On top of this, V2 adds a premium 3D / motion interaction layer (tilt/parallax, considered transitions) that gives a more modern feel than Legacy's static pages.

8 Real data vs. hardcoded values

A concrete Legacy weakness was baked-in content. V2 replaced these with live tokens:

- **Support phone number** — was hardcoded into footer markup; now reads the dynamic store-config token, matching the header's source.
- **"Latest From The Blog" cards** — were rendering placeholder/dummy content (a generic "NEWS" token); now source real blog-post fields with a graceful fallback if unreachable.
- **Link targets** — every nav / footer / help-center link verified against real template files and real Miva `&mvt:url:...auto;` tokens; no guessed or broken URLs.

9 Defects found & fixed

During the footer and navigation audit this session, four defects were confirmed and addressed:

#	Issue	Where	Fix
1	Hardcoded support phone baked into footer markup instead of a store-config token	<code>cssui-global-footer-v2.mvt</code>	Replaced with dynamic token matching header
2	"Latest From The Blog" cards rendered placeholder/dummy content, not real posts	<code>cssui-global-footer-v2.mvt</code>	Wired to real blog data with fallback
3	Stale/incorrect environment comment left from an earlier pass	<code>cssui-global-footer-v2.mvt</code>	Removed
4	SearchSpring still wired into every page <code><head></code> despite being cancelled	<code>cssui-global-head.mvt</code>	Confirmed inactive — flagged only, no removal without sign-off

Across the Help Center (hub + 6 sub-pages) and mega-menu audits: **0 broken links, 0 missing templates, 0 dead nav targets.**

10 Third-party / dependency risk

SEARCHSPRING — CONFIRMED INACTIVE

The SearchSpring third-party search/merchandising integration was still referenced in the global `<head>` but is fully inert. Confirming this de-risks the pending subscription cancellation — but per governance it was flagged, not removed, without sign-off.

PRE-EXISTING RISK — SPONS.MVT

`templates/spons.mvt` contains a hardcoded monday.com API token in client-side JS. This is a **pre-existing** live-credential exposure (not introduced by V2) and was left untouched per the "restyle only, don't touch API/token logic" rule. It needs manual rotation in monday.com settings.

11 Feature-by-feature comparison

Area	Legacy site	V2 revamp
Styling source	Per-template inline / duplicated CSS	One shared token system (<code>css/sd2-global.css</code>)
Components	Copy-pasted markup per page	Reusable canonical partials
Data	Some hardcoded values (phone, blog cards)	Real store/blog tokens with fallback
Consistency	Drifts page to page	Consistent by construction
Maintainability	Change many files to update one thing	Change one token/partial, updates everywhere
JavaScript	Ad-hoc / mixed	Shared, dependency-free, fail-closed modules
Accessibility / motion	Not systematized	Reduced-motion branch required everywhere
Link integrity	Mixed / unaudited	Audited against real templates & tokens
Third-party risk	SearchSpring wired into every page	Confirmed inert, de-risking cancellation
Motion / feel	Static	3D / premium interaction layer
Brand direction	Generic catalog feel	Engineered performance-garage identity

12 Why V2 is better — reasoned

- 1 **Consistent by construction** — shared tokens mean the whole site looks and behaves the same way. Inconsistency can't creep in per page because there is no per-page styling to drift.
- 2 **Dramatically easier to maintain** — one change to a token or partial propagates everywhere, instead of editing many duplicated Legacy templates and risking missed spots.
- 3 **More trustworthy content** — real store/blog data replaces hardcoded and dummy values, so the site stays accurate as the business changes, with graceful fallbacks when a source is unreachable.
- 4 **Lower risk** — link targets verified against real templates/tokens, and the cancelled SearchSpring dependency confirmed inert before any removal.
- 5 **More resilient frontend** — dependency-free JS that fails closed, guards `localStorage`, and centralizes gallery/garage logic reduces breakage surface.
- 6 **More accessible & modern** — required reduced-motion branches plus a premium 3D/motion layer deliver a more inclusive and more premium experience than static Legacy pages.

13 Migration approach & safety

V2 follows a strict, milestone-based process (M0–M9): Creative exploration → Foundation → Global Components → Homepage → Category/Listing → Search → PDP → Cart/Checkout → Dashboard → Final Polish. Work proceeds one milestone at a time — no skipping, no rebuilding completed milestones.

HARD ACTIVATION RULES

- V2 is built **inactive**; creating/editing a file never puts it live.
- **Never overwrite or activate** `sfnt.mvt`, `srch.mvt`, `prod-product_display.mvt`, or live header/footer/checkout/basket/account templates with V2 files.
- Legacy templates are never deleted. One design system only. No inline scripts/styles in partials.

Two batches of **live** templates were restyled in place to the V2 shell (account/order templates and static content / help pages) — an intentional exception documented in `V2_STRUCTURE.md`.

14 Outstanding work & known risks

V2 is a real improvement in **foundation**, but it is not finished:

STILL OUTSTANDING

- V2 templates are **not activated** yet — Milestones M3–M9 (Homepage, Category/Listing, Search, PDP, Cart/Checkout, Dashboard, Final Polish) not started.
- Many partials contain `[Placeholder]` content not yet wired to live Miva arrays: homepage media, search suggestions/guides/no-results, financing/warranty/delivery/rating/gallery, PDP gallery/video/specs/reviews/related/bundles, cart recommendations/shipping/coupon/tax/review, dashboard order rows/tracking/invoices/timeline/addresses/returns/settings, and CTGY product-array wiring.
- Blog footer card **images** are still placeholder graphics (content/photo gap, not a code bug).
- `prod-product_display-v2-test.mvt` has real Miva wiring only for name/price/image/description/add-to-cart; breadcrumbs, extra media, video, spec fields, reviews, related products, and bundles remain placeholders.
- No human browser/visual QA yet — fixes are template/code-level verified only. Manual review of the staging URL is required before sign-off.

Sources: `V2_REVAMP_REPORT.md` and `DOCUMENTATION.md` (which summarize `V2_CONSTITUTION.md` and `V2_STRUCTURE.md` — the authoritative specs). This brief consolidates those; where any detail conflicts, the governing spec files win. · Sinister Diesel V2 Revamp · Engine: Miva Merchant (unchanged)